PPP-P-1260B
April 18, 1974
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. PPP-P-001260A(GSA-FSS)
August 9, 1967

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PLYWOOD, PACKAGING, PACKING, AND MARKING OF

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the packaging, packing, and marking of various grades and sizes of plywood.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

QQ-S-781 - Strapping, Steel, Flat and Seals.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard; Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes.
PPP-V-205 - Veneer, Paper Overlaid, Container Grade.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:51Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

U. S. Department of Commerce:

CS-157 - Pine Plywood (Ponderosa Pine, Sugar Pine and Idaho White Pine).
PS-1 - Softwood Plywood, Construction and Industrial.
PS-51 - Hardwood and Decorative Plywood.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The material used in the packaging and packing of plywood shall be as specified herein. The material shall be free from all defects and imperfections which may affect its serviceability.

3.2 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

3.2.1 Levels A and B. Plywood, of like grade and size, shall be packaged in type I, type III, or type IV packages as specified in 6.1.

3.2.1.1 Type I. The number of sheets of plywood shown in table I shall be stacked flat with the better grade surface facing inward. Each bundle shall be secured by two flat steel straps conforming to QQ-S-781, type I or IV, class A or B, size 1/2 x 0.020 inches placed girthwise approximately 24 inches from each end of the bundle. The straps shall be staggered so the bundles will fit compactly together when secured in unit loads. A metal or plastic edge protector, of sufficient size to prevent indenting the panel, shall be placed under the steel straps at each edge.

TABLE I. Packaging and packing quantities

Thickness	Sheets per package	No. of packages to skid	No. of sheets to skid
1/4 in.	12	10	120
5/16 in.	10	10	100
3/8 in.	8	10	80
1/2 in.	6	10	60
5/8 in.	5	10	50
3/4 in.	4	10	40
1 in.	3	10	30

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:51Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.1.2 Type III. The number of sheets of plywood shown in table I shall be stacked flat with the better grade surface facing inward and placed in a kraft paper bag. The bag shall be an asphalt laminated reinforced kraft paper (35/75/35) flat satchel bottom bag, having a full length kraft reinforcing strip approximately 2 inches wide on each of the four lengthwise inside edges of the bag installed so a 1 inch minimum reinforcement extends over each lengthwise inside edge. The kraft paper used in the bag construction shall be 35 pound basis weight liner, 75 pound basis weight asphalt impregnated with fiberglass reinforcements and 35 pound basis weight liner. Lengthwise reinforcement strips shall be 70 pound basis weight liner glued flat on the inside of the bag. After filling, the bags shall be closed by means of self seal latex adhesive.

3.2.1.3 Type IV. The number of sheets of plywood shown in table I shall be stacked flat with the better grade surface facing inward and packaged in a telescoping style, close-fitting fiberboard box. The fiberboard used in the fabrication of the box shall conform to PPP-F-320, class domestic, type CF, variety SW, grade 175 minimum. The box shall provide physical protection for all edges and faces of the plywood. The box shall be closed by adhesive or heavy duty clincher type staples placed approximately every six inches along the sides and ends of the box.

3.2.2 Level C. The number of sheets of plywood shown in table I shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's standard commercial practice.

3.3 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

3.3.1 Level A. Plywood of one length, width, thickness, and description shall be packed as shown in figure 1 in quantities as shown in table I except that to complete a shipment, the last pack of each size and description may contain a lesser number of panels than specified in table I. Plywood shall be stacked so as to provide a square edge on one side and one end of each pack. The better grade facing of the top and bottom panels shall be placed toward the center of the pack. When specified (see 6.2), wood battens shall be applied under each girthwise strap as shown in figure 1. The top and bottom of each stack of plywood having face veneers grade 2 or better conforming to PS-51, or grade B or better conforming to PS-1 or CS-157 shall be protected by waster sheets of plywood 1/4 inch thick (minimum thickness) and of the same length and width as the plywood panels in the pack. Sides and ends of the stack shall be protected by plywood waster sheets not less than 1/4 inch thick and of sufficient length and width to completely cover all sides and ends of the plywood in the stack. For packs over 96 inches long, 3/4 inch lumber may be substituted for the plywood side and end waster sheets. Strapping shall conform to QQ-S-781, type I or IV, class B, or QQ-S-790, class A, sizes and locations as shown in figure 1, except that all packs over 144 inches long shall have a fourth girthwise strap. Intermediate girthwise straps shall be positioned at equal distance from the end straps and from each other. Longitudinal straps shall pass between the stack and battens, not over the battens. Edge protectors shall be used at all edges under the straps except on the ends of the battens. The strapping shall be properly tensioned and sealed.

3.3.2 Level B. Plywood of one length, width, thickness, and description shall be packed in quantities as shown in table I, except that to complete a shipment, the last pack of each size and description may contain a lesser number of panels than specified in table I. The number of unit packages or the number of loose panels shall be packed in accordance with figure 2 or 3, except that in lieu of applying the 1 inch by 4 inch battens on top of the plywood stack, they may be nailed to the 2 inch by 4 inch runners, provided that edge protectors are used under the strapping at the top edges of the plywood stack. In lieu of the 1 inch by 4 inch battens plus the 2 inch by 4 inch runners on the bottom, nominal 3 inch by 4 inch runners shall be used. Plywood having face veneer grade 2 or better conforming to PS-51, or grade B or better conforming to PS-1 shall be protected by waster sheets placed on the top and bottom of each stack. The waster sheets shall be of equal length and width as the plywood panels in the pack and shall be plywood that is at least 1/4 inch thick, paper overlaid veneer conforming to PPP-V-205 with a minimum thickness of 0.210 inch, or corrugated fiberboard conforming to PPP-F-320. The stack shall be compressed under a load of 4,000 pounds minimum and secured with strapping conforming to QQ-S-781, type I or IV, class A or B, with a minimum breaking strength of 2,000 pounds. The runners may be provided with a groove on the bottom into which the strapping can fit. If the runners do not have a groove, the strapping shall be stapled to the bottom runners.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T12:51Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3.3.3 Level C. Plywood of one length, width, thickness, and description shall be packed in quantities as shown in table I to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the Uniform Freight Classification or the National Motor Freight Classification Rules as applicable.

3.4 Marking.

3.4.1 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked on one side with the following information:

(a) Federal Stock Number.
(b) Item description, including Commercial or Product Standard Number, type, and grade.
(c) Size - length, width, and thickness.
(d) Quantity - i.e., number of sheets.
(e) Contract and purchase order number.
(f) Contractor's name.
(g) Gross weight.

The other side shall be marked with the Federal Stock Number.

3.4.2 Shipping container.

3.4.2.1 Packaged plywood. The shipping container consisting of unit packages shall require no further marking.

3.4.2.2 Unpackaged plywood.

3.4.2.2.1 Civil agencies. The shipping container of unpackaged plywood shall be marked with the markings specified in 3.4.1 for unit packages. The markings shall be applied in 3/4 inch characters.

3.4.2.2.2 Military activities.

3.4.2.2.2.1 Marking for identification. Each pack shall be marked with the following information:

(a) Contract or order number.
(b) Type and species.
(c) Number of plies per panel.
(d) Panel thickness.
(e) Quantity.
(f) Gross weight.

3.4.2.2.2.2 Marking for shipping. Marking for shipment shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that suppliers and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:51Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.3 Inspection. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking as required by this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored as specified in table II. The sample unit shall be one skid load of plywood fully prepared for delivery. The lot shall be the number of skid loads offered for delivery at one time. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Classification of defects

Examination	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as loose strapping, inadequate stapling, improperly placed edge protectors or distortion of containers and skid loads.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

Section 5 is not applicable to this specification.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The requirements of this specification are intended to be used for the packaging, packing, and marking of various grades and sizes of plywood furnished to agencies of the Government, For levels A and B packaging the different grades of plywood shall be packaged as follows.

6.1.1 Grades AA and AB. Grades AA and AB plywood shall be packaged in type III or type IV packages only (see 3.2.1.2 and 3.2.1.3).

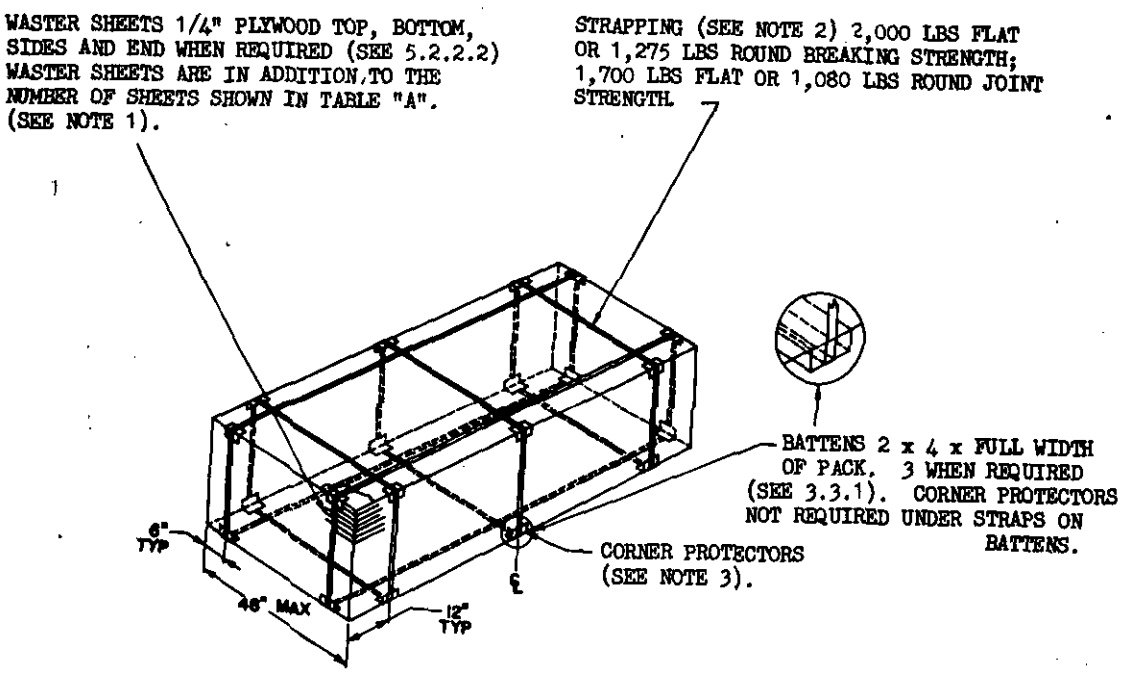
6.1.2 Grades AC and AD. Grades AC and AD plywood shall be packaged in type I, type III, or type IV packages at the option of the supplier (see 3.2.1.1, 3.2.1.2, and 3.2.1.3).

6.1.3 Grades BB, CC, and standard. Grades BB, CC, and standard plywood shall be packaged in type I packages (see 3.2.1.1).

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Level of packaging (see 3.2).
(c) Level of packing (see 3.3).
(d) When wood battens shall be applied under each girthwise strap (see 3.3.1).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:51Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



NOTE 1 - BOTTOM WASTER SHEET: SHALL BE NAILED AT 2 POINTS TO EACH BATTEN (WHEN BATTENS ARE REQUIRED) PRIOR TO ASSEMBLY OF PACK.

NOTE 2 - STRAPPING: GIRTHWISE STRAPS APPLIED OVER LENGTHWISE STRAPS. GIRTHWISE STRAPS APPLIED OVER BATTENS (WHEN BATTENS ARE REQUIRED) AND STAPLED TO BATTENS EVERY 6" WITH 3/4" LEG, 14 GAGE, CEMENT COATED STAPLES.

NOTE 3 - EDGE PROTECTORS: METAL, NOT LESS THAN 1-1/2" IN WIDTH, A LEG LENGTH NOT LESS THAN 1", NOT LESS THAN 0.022" IN THICKNESS, EMBOSSED VERTICAL RIDGE ON EACH SIDE OF STRAPPING LOCATION.

FIGURE 1. Level A packing.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:51Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

PACKING OF PLYWOOD

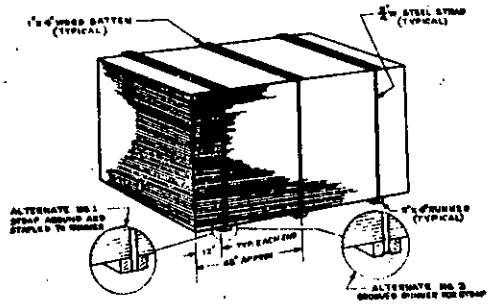
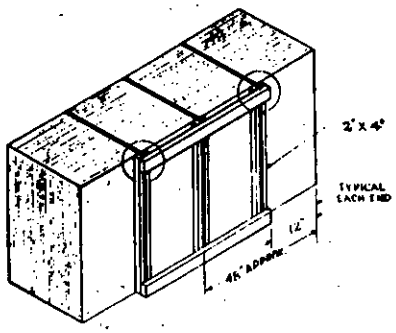


FIGURE 3. Four way entry lift.

PACKING OF PLYWOOD



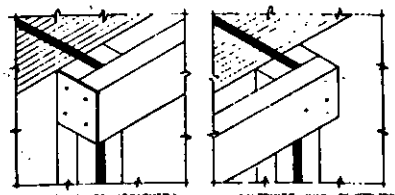


FIGURE 2. Two way entry lift.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:51Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army - SM
Navy - AS
Air Force - 84

Review activities:

Army - SM, GL, MU, ME
Navy - YD
Air Force - 84
DSA - CS, DP

User activities:

Army - ME
Navy - SA, SH
Air Force - 84
DSA - CS

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATION ACTIVITIES:

GSA - FSS, PBO
USDA - AFS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with the General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:51Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.